

Plus500 CFD · Trade Notes

Product rationale & desktop wireframes · Home assignment · June 2026

● The problem & business impact

About 80% of retail CFD accounts at Plus500 lose money.¹ The main reason is not lack of knowledge, it is behavior: traders enter on emotion (fear of missing out, and revenge after a loss), don't learn from their mistakes, and repeat them until the account is gone. A trader who loses his money leaves.

In 2025 Plus500 acquired ~104,500 new customers, yet its active base actually **shrank** (254,138 to ~242,000).² The company spends heavily on acquisition just to stand still. **Trade Notes is a retention play:** a trader who learns and survives longer stays a customer, which is a **direct saving in acquisition cost and a lift in lifetime value**.

● Who it is for

Any trader who wants to improve, beginner or experienced. For example, the trader who keeps buying back in right after a loss to win it back. He *knows* it is a mistake, but emotion beats logic at the moment of entry, and he never stops to see the pattern repeat.

● Why traders will actually use it

Most journals die because logging is a separate chore. Here the note is captured **inside the trade flow, in one tap, never required**. The AI does the analysis, so even short notes pay off, and the trader sees value fast, which builds the habit.

● The solution: a simple core, then an AI layer

The core ships on its own and answers the brief directly: **one note that travels with each trade**. An AI layer then learns from those notes.

- 1. The note thread (this is the MVP).** One note that accompanies the trade at every stage: planning, entry, while open, closing, and summary. Free text, or a one-tap tag. This alone is a complete, shippable Trade Notes feature.
- 2. The AI layer (the next phase, what makes it intelligent).** It reads the notes and gives insights and recommendations about **you** (for example "most of your losses mention 'gut feeling'", or "before a reversal, wait for confirmation"), and brings the right note back at a similar moment. It looks inward at your behavior, not at the market, and never gives buy/sell calls. It complements +AI Bites, which looks outward.
- 3. Flexibility through simple settings.** A few toggles let each trader decide how present the tool is, from full guidance to just a free note box. It never blocks or forces.
- 4. Native to Plus500.** Everything sits on existing screens (order ticket, open position, closed positions), so it feels natural and is cheap to build.

Deliberately out of scope for now: full analytics dashboards, a daily-loss stop, and importing an existing journal (Excel/CSV) to seed the AI. The first release stays focused on the note itself.

How we will know it works: % of active traders who adopt Trade Notes (feature adoption, not just overall retention) · share of trades that include a note (depth of use) · fewer repeated emotional entries · longer active lifespan per trader · improved 30 and 90 day retention.

Sources:

¹ ~76-80% of retail CFD accounts lose money (ESMA-mandated risk warning), per Plus500's site and industry summaries: [plus500.com](https://www.plus500.com/en/plus500-risk-warning) · [Good Money Guide, Risk Warning Statistics](#)

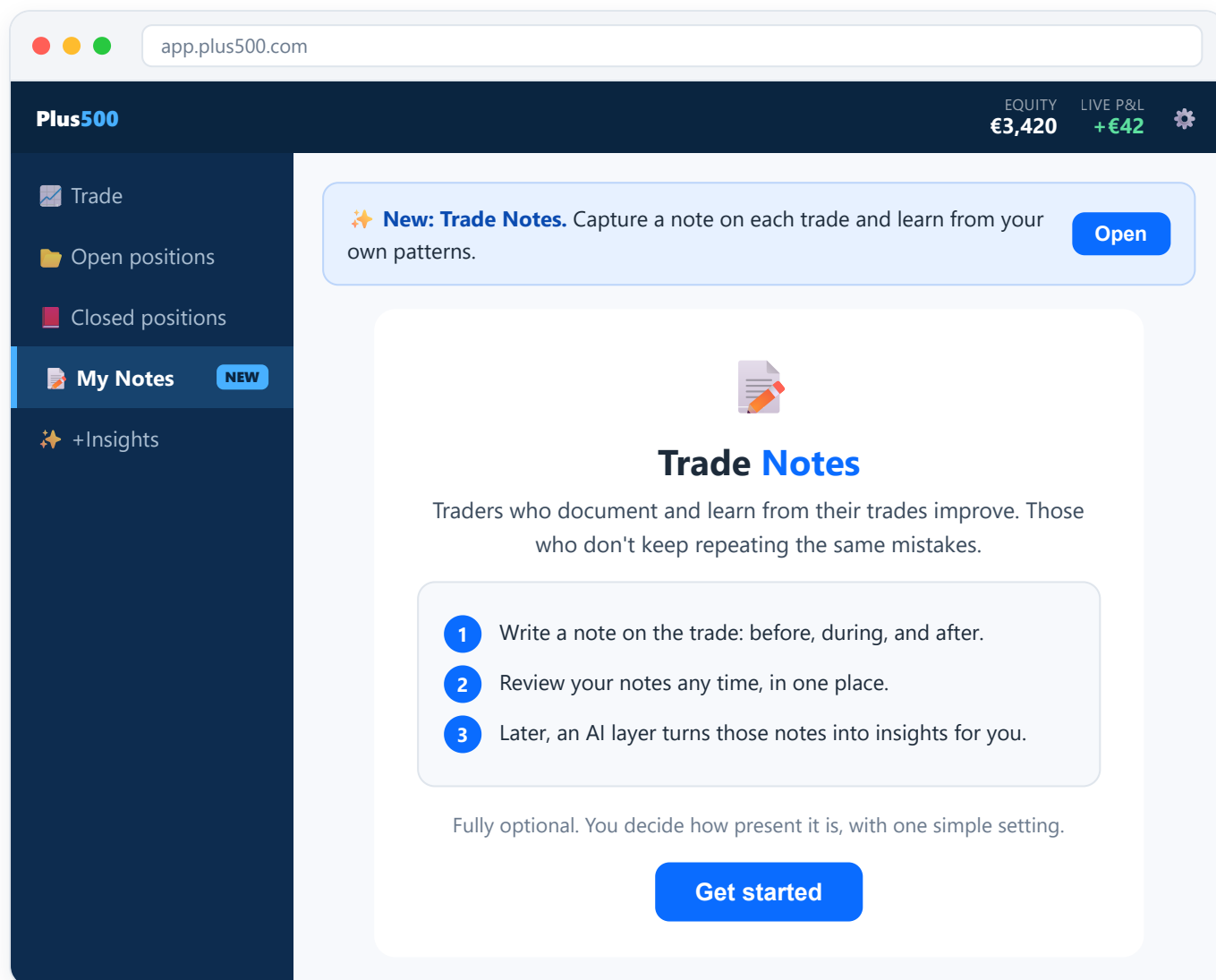
² Customer figures (118,010 new in 2024, ~104,500 in 2025; active 254,138 vs ~242,000), from Plus500's official results: [Plus500 Investor Relations](#) · [Finance Magnates](#)

Wireframes · Desktop

Read as two parts: Part 1 is the Trade Notes feature itself (the MVP). Part 2 is the AI layer that learns from the notes.

Part 1 · Trade Notes (MVP) capturing notes across the life of a trade

Screen 0 · Finding Trade Notes, and the one-time intro



You reach Trade Notes from the new **"My Notes"** menu item, the note field on the order ticket, or a one-time launch banner. This intro appears once.

Screen 1 · Entry: the note begins, inside the trading screen

app.plus500.com/trade

Plus500

EQUITY
€3,420

AVAILABLE
€2,980

LIVE P&L
+€42

⚙

Gold
2,658.4 ▲0.3%

EUR/USD
1.0821 ▼0.1%

US 500
5,540 ▲0.6%

Oil
78.92 ▼0.4%

Bitcoin
68,120 ▲1.2%

Gold · XAU/USD
2,658.4

Gold
XAU/USD
CFD

2,658.4

Amount
1.00

Leverage
x20

Close at Profit
2,678.0 ☒

Close at Loss
2,648.0 ☒

Advanced >

My note NEW

What's the plan? Why am I entering now?...

Or tag in one tap (optional):

Technical Fundamental Gut feeling

Sell Buy

The **note thread begins** right on the existing order ticket, next to Close at Profit/Loss and Advanced. Free text, or a single tap.

Screen 2 · While open: the note lives with the trade

The screenshot shows the Plus500 web interface. At the top, the browser address bar displays 'app.plus500.com/positions'. The Plus500 logo is on the left, and account details (EQUITY: €3,420, LIVE P&L: +€42) and a settings gear are on the right. The main content area features a 'Gold' trade card for 'XAU/USD · CFD' with a '+€42' profit. Below the trade name is an 'OPEN POSITION' button. The trade notes section includes a 'PLAN' icon and text: 'Waited for a reversal around 2,660.', an 'ENTRY' icon and text: 'Entered on a reversal at 2,660, waiting for candle confirmation.', and a '+ Add a note now (price nearing target, what do I do?)' button with a dashed border.

Gold
XAU/USD · CFD +€42
OPEN POSITION

PLAN
"Waited for a reversal around 2,660."

ENTRY
"Entered on a reversal at 2,660, waiting for candle confirmation."

+ Add a note now (price nearing target, what do I do?)

What ordinary journals miss. **You can add a note at any stage, including while the position is open.**

Screen 3 · Close & summary: what happened and what I learned

app.plus500.com/positions

Plus500

EQUITY
€3,360

LIVE P&L
€0

Trade closed: Gold
XAU/USD · CFD

–€84

ENTRY

"Entered on a reversal at 2,660, waiting for confirmation."

WHILE OPEN

"It went against me, I held because I was sure it would turn."

Close & summary

NOW

What happened? What worked, what didn't, what will you do differently?

I entered too early without waiting for confirmation. Next time I'll wait for the candle to close...

Tag the lesson (optional):

Entered too early

Gut feeling

Followed plan

Skip

Save note

The most important moment for learning. **When the trade closes, the trader writes what happened and what he learned**, completing the thread.

Screen 4 · My Notes: review your own trades

The screenshot shows the Plus500 web application interface. The top navigation bar includes the Plus500 logo, the user's equity (€3,360), and a settings gear icon. A left sidebar contains navigation links: Trade, Open positions, Closed positions, My Notes (highlighted), and +Insights. The main content area is titled 'My Notes' and includes a 'This month' filter dropdown. It displays two trade entries:

- Gold** XAU/USD · CFD Jun 4: Outcome **-€84**.
 - Entry: "Reversal at 2,660, gut feeling it would turn."
 - While open: "Went against me, held because I was sure."
 - Summary: "Entered too early. Next time wait for confirmation."
- US 500** Index · CFD Jun 3: Outcome **+€142**.
 - Entry: "Breakout above resistance, waited for the candle."
 - Summary: "The plan worked when I was patient."

Notes are reviewable here, and each one also appears on its trade under **Closed positions**. The note lives where the trade lives.

Screen 5 · First use: the empty state

The screenshot shows the Plus500 web application interface in an empty state. The top navigation bar and left sidebar are identical to the previous screen. The main content area is titled 'My Notes' and includes a 'This month' filter dropdown. It displays a message:

No notes yet

Your notes will appear here. Add a quick note on your next trade, the why behind it, and what you learn when it closes.

[Add a note on your next trade](#)

A friendly first-run state matters: it explains the value and removes the "blank page" barrier that kills journaling habits.

Part 2 · The AI layer turning the notes into insight, as a fast follow

Screen 6 · AI insights & recommendations, from your own notes

The screenshot shows the Plus500 app interface. The top bar displays the Plus500 logo and the user's equity of €3,360. The left sidebar contains navigation options: Trade, Open positions, Closed positions, My Notes (highlighted), and +Insights. The main content area is titled "What the AI learns from your notes" and lists two insights: "Most of your losses mention 'gut feeling' or entering too early." and "Your winning trades almost always mention waiting for confirmation." Below these, a recommendation box states: "Recommendation: before entering a reversal, wait for a confirmation candle to close. This is the pattern that recurs in your winning trades." A final note mentions: "This month you wrote 14 notes, and 'gut feeling' trades dropped from 9 to 3. You are improving."

The AI reads your notes and reflects patterns about **you, not the market**. The quick-tags give it a clean structured signal alongside the free text, so insights hold even when notes are short or messy. It advises on your process only; **it never predicts the market or places buy/sell calls** (important under CFD regulation).

Screen 7 · Smart reminder: your note comes back to you

The screenshot shows the Plus500 app interface for a trade. The top bar displays the Plus500 logo and the user's equity of €3,360. The left sidebar contains navigation options: Trade, Open positions, Closed positions, My Notes, and +Insights. The main content area shows a trade setup for Gold (XAU/USD) with a price of 2,663.1. The trade parameters are: Amount 1.00, Leverage x20, and Advanced options. There are "Sell" and "Buy" buttons. A blue callout box titled "Hold on, this looks familiar" contains a reminder: "You wrote this on a similar Gold trade: 'I entered too early without waiting for confirmation. Next time I'll wait for the candle to close.'" Below the reminder is a button "Write a note this time" and a close button (X).

At a similar moment, the AI brings back the note you wrote. **Gentle, never blocking**. This is where the trader feels the value of documenting.

Screen 8 · Settings: flexibility lives here

app.plus500.com/settings/trade-notes

TRADE NOTES (MVP)

Trade Notes

The note on each trade

Guiding questions

Prompts for plan and summary, for those who want guidance

AI LAYER

AI insights

Personal insights drawn from your own notes

Smart reminder

Brings your note back at a similar moment

Same tool, minimal or rich, per trader. A beginner turns everything on; an expert keeps only a free note box.